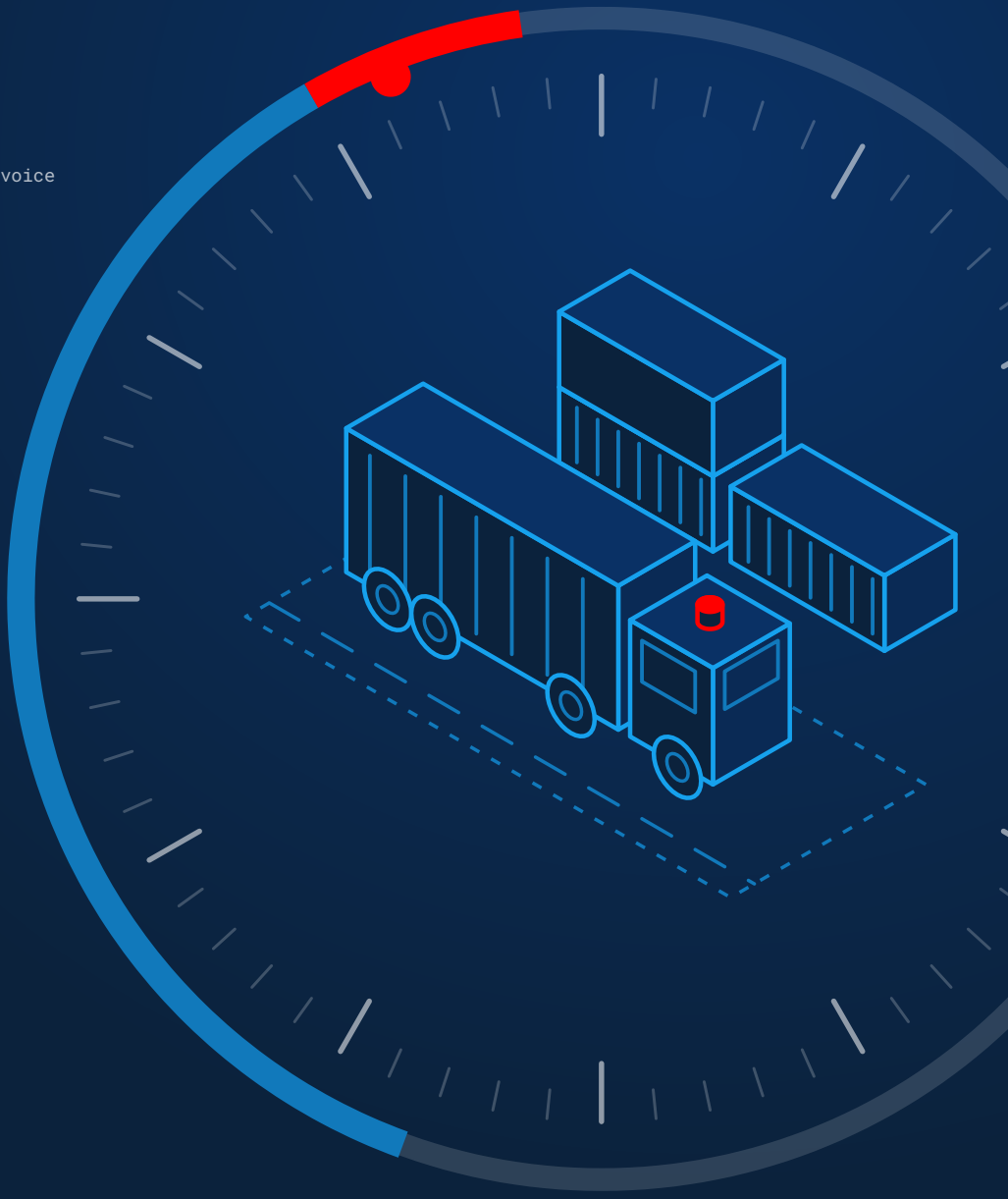
CRISIS PLAYBOOK · NO. 04

WEEK OF 30 NOVEMBER 2026

- T+00:00 Incident declared
- T+00:02 Alert sent · push, SMS, voice
- T+01:30 Escalated · no response
- T+04:10 Team acknowledged



TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS

Keep it moving.

Hub and depot incidents, storms, IT and cyber outages, failed suppliers and drivers on their own at 3am. How to reroute, inform and protect people in the first hour, and what to fix before winter.

T+00:00 · T+00:05 · T+00:15 · T+01:00 · T+04:00

INSIDE

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A practical playbook for transport and logistics leaders: how to keep people, goods and passengers moving, and staff safe, when a hub goes dark, the weather turns, a system fails or a driver stops answering.

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FOREWORD

In transport, nobody fails alone. One fault becomes everyone's problem within the hour.

On 21 March 2025 Heathrow closed for most of a day after a fire at the North Hyde substation in west London. More than 270,000 passenger journeys were disrupted.[1] The official review found that losing one of the airport's three supply points cut power to some operationally critical systems, and that reconfiguring the airport's network to run on the other two would take an estimated 10 to 12 hours.[2]

Six months later a ransomware attack on a check-in system supplier forced staff at Heathrow, Brussels and Berlin back to handwritten boarding passes.[3] A cyber attack halted production at Jaguar Land Rover for five weeks and left its suppliers waiting for orders and payments.[4,5] And on 8 September 2026 a software defect in the UK's air traffic system delayed, cancelled or diverted more than 2,000 flights.[6]

This playbook is for the people who hold it together when that happens: operations, resilience, security, safety and communications leaders in airports, ports, rail, bus and coach, freight and logistics. It sets out how to grade and escalate an incident, who decides what, what to do in the first hour, how to keep drivers and lone workers safe and how to bring contractors and partners into one response. It also gives you tools to use: a roles matrix, check-in and notification logs, a tabletop exercise, an actions tracker and a review template. The companion intelligence report sets out the evidence in full.

The Crises Control team
Crises Control

INTRODUCTION

Three things keep a network moving on a bad day.

Transport and logistics run on tight timings, shared assets and many hands. When something breaks, the operators that recover fastest are not the ones with the thickest plans. They are the ones that know where the network is fragile, who must hear first and how to reach every person in it.

Know your single points of failure

One power intake, one planning system, one supplier or one control room can stop a whole network. Find them, test the fallback and know how long it lasts.

Reach everyone, by more than one route

Staff, drivers, contractors, partners, customers and passengers each need the right message, fast, with a record of who has acknowledged and who has not.

People before payload

Every decision starts with the safety of passengers, crews, drivers and lone workers. Freight can wait in a yard. A driver who has stopped answering cannot.

Disruption travels faster than freight.

A fault at one hub, airport or control room reaches drivers, partners and passengers within minutes. The first hour decides whether they hear it from you, with clear instructions, or work it out for themselves.

PART 01

Before it hits.

Find where your network is fragile, agree how to grade an incident and fix the gaps the recent reviews exposed.

01 Why transport incidents spread

02 Six disruptions, first moves

03 Severity and escalation

04 Who decides: roles and responsibilities

05 Readiness in six steps

BEFORE IT HITS

Your network is only as strong as the parts you do not own

> **Incident management in this sector is mostly about the space between organisations.**

A transport or logistics operation is a chain of dependencies. Power comes from a network operator. Planning, booking and check-in run on systems built by suppliers. Track, airspace, roads and berths belong to someone else. Drivers, handlers and engineers are often contractors or agency staff. When one link fails, the effect lands somewhere else: at a gate, a loading bay, a platform or a lay-by.

The recent reviews make the point clearly. At Heathrow, the risk that one supply point might fail was understood at a technical level but less well known outside the technical team.[7] After the 2023 failure of the UK's flight planning system, several airlines and airports first heard about it from the media.[8] In September 2025, airports that had done nothing wrong lost their check-in desks because a supplier was attacked.[3]

So incident management in this sector is mostly about the space between organisations. Who tells the partner sites? Who tells the drivers already on the road? Who decides to divert, and who tells the customer whose delivery will now be late? Who checks that the contractor on the night shift is out of the building?

That means three things have to be settled before anything happens. A severity scale that every site and partner understands. A map of who must be told, in what order, by what route. And a clear way to account for people, from passengers in a terminal to a driver parked alone at a closed depot.

None of this is exotic. Much of it is in the recommendations of the reviews that followed Heathrow and the air traffic failures: a second way to reach key people, earlier warnings to partners and a standard set of information for passengers.[1,9] The work is in making it true across sites, shifts and suppliers before winter, not during the next incident.

SIX DISRUPTIONS

Six disruptions and the first moves that matter

What to do in the first fifteen minutes, before the cause is clear.

DISRUPTION	FIRST OPERATIONAL MOVE	FIRST PEOPLE AND COMMUNICATION MOVE
Hub, depot, port or airport incident	Make the site safe. Stop inbound movements. Decide hold, divert or close.	Account for staff, contractors and visiting drivers. Tell partner sites and drivers on the road.
Power loss	Confirm what is on backup and how long it will last. Ask the network operator for an estimate.[2]	Alert the incident team by two routes. Warn customers that services from the site may stop.
Severe weather	Act on Met Office warnings before they peak: pre-position, cancel early, protect exposed routes.[10]	Tell drivers and crews where to stop safely. Tell passengers and customers early, with what to do.
IT or cyber outage	Switch to manual or offline procedures. Isolate if attack is suspected. Keep evidence.	Tell sites what still works and what not to touch. Prepare a regulator notification.
Supplier or system failure	Ask the supplier for scope and a time. Move to the fallback you agreed in advance.[3]	Tell affected partners and customers once, plainly, with the next update time.
Driver or lone worker not responding	Follow the missed check-in procedure at once. Do not wait for the end of the shift.[11]	Call, then locate, then send help. Tell the family only through the agreed route.

SEVERITY

A transport severity ladder for every site and partner

Grade early and regrade often. If in doubt, go one level higher and step down later.

SEV 1

Critical

TRIGGERS

A hub, port, terminal or depot closed. Power, IT or a critical supplier lost across the network. Confirmed cyber attack on operations. A fatality, serious injury or missing driver. A red weather warning on key routes.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Crisis team, all affected site leads, safety, security, IT, communications, legal and key partners.

`Voice · SMS · push · bridge in 15 min`

SEV 2

Major

TRIGGERS

One site partly down. An amber warning across a region. A planning, booking or check-in system failing. A road collision with injury. A credible threat to a crew or driver.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Incident manager, site and regional leads, IT or engineering on call, communications on standby.

`SMS · push · escalate after 10 min`

SEV 3

Moderate

TRIGGERS

A single depot or route affected. A breakdown in an unsafe place. A partner running late. A lone worker check-in missed by up to 30 minutes.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Site lead, transport planner or controller, service desk.

`Push · email`

SEV 4

Minor

TRIGGERS

Short delays, a single device fault, a near miss or an abusive passenger without injury.

WHO IS ALERTED, HOW

Site lead, recorded for trend reporting and the weekly review.

`App · email`

ESCALATION

Who is told, and who decides, at each level

Severity says how bad it is. Escalation says who must act. Times are illustrative: set your own and test them out of hours.

	TRIGGER	WHO IS ALERTED	WHO DECIDES
LEVEL 1 **Site or depot**	A local fault, a delayed vehicle, a breakdown in an unsafe place or a single missed check-in (SEV 3 to 4).	Depot or hub lead and the network controller on shift.	Depot or hub lead

↓ ESCALATE IF IT IS NOT CONTAINED WITHIN 30 MINUTES, MORE THAN ONE SITE IS HIT OR ANYONE IS HURT

	TRIGGER	WHO IS ALERTED	WHO DECIDES
LEVEL 2 **Network control**	More than one site or route affected, a planning or check-in system failing, or a key partner running late (SEV 2 to 3).	Network controller, incident manager, IT or engineering on call.	Incident manager

↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS NO RESTORATION TIME, CUSTOMERS OR PASSENGERS WILL BE AFFECTED, OR A DRIVER IS STILL NOT FOUND

	TRIGGER	WHO IS ALERTED	WHO DECIDES
LEVEL 3 **Incident team**	A hub or terminal partly down, an amber warning across a region, a suspected cyber attack or a driver missing after the check-in procedure (SEV 2).	Incident team, health and safety, communications, IT and key partners.	Operations director: hold, divert or cancel

↓ ESCALATE IF A SITE CLOSES, THERE IS SERIOUS INJURY, A CONFIRMED ATTACK OR MEDIA INTEREST

	TRIGGER	WHO IS ALERTED	WHO DECIDES
LEVEL 4 **Crisis team**	A hub, port, terminal or depot closed, network-wide loss of power, IT or a critical supplier, a fatality or a red warning on key routes (SEV 1).	Executive team, legal, all site leads, partners and, where required, regulators.	Chief operating officer or accountable executive

If a decision maker has not acknowledged within five minutes, alert their deputy by a second route and record it. The Heathrow review recommended a second means of contact for significant incidents.[1]

ROLES

Who does what in a network incident

Illustrative roles for an operator with hubs, depots and drivers on the road. One person is accountable for each activity; agree the names and deputies before you need them.

ACTIVITY	OPERATIONS DIRECTOR	INCIDENT MANAGER	NETWORK CONTROL	DEPOT OR HUB LEAD	HEALTH AND SAFETY	COMMS AND CUSTOMER SERVICE
Raise the first alert from site	·	I	I	A	I	·
Declare the incident and set severity	I	A	C	C	I	I
Account for everyone on site	·	I	·	A	R	·
Stop inbound vehicles and hold drivers safely	I	C	A	C	C	·
Run the missed check-in escalation	·	I	A	C	R	·
Decide to hold, divert or cancel	A	R	C	C	C	I
Tell partner sites, hauliers and suppliers	I	A	R	I	·	C
Tell customers and passengers	C	C	I	·	·	A
Speak to the media	A	C	·	·	C	R
Decide on regulator notification	A	R	·	·	C	C
Approve the return to normal operations	A	R	C	C	C	I

R Responsible: does the work A Accountable: owns the decision C Consulted I Informed

> Drivers and crews are not on this matrix because they never decide alone in a crisis: they act on one instruction from network control and acknowledge it. Make sure every driver knows who that is on each shift.

READINESS

Readiness in six steps

Each step comes from a lesson in a recent official review. Finish them before the winter peak.

01 Map your single points of failure

Power intakes, control rooms, planning and check-in systems, fuel and key suppliers. At Heathrow, losing one of three supply points cut power to critical systems.[2]

02 Test backup for duration, not just start-up

Find out how long each backup source lasts. Heathrow's review found nearly all emergency power on the affected supply would have run out before main power returned.[7]

03 Give every key person a second route

The Heathrow review recommended a second means of contact for significant incidents, in addition to the existing alert calls.[1]

04 Check on-call staff can actually act

In 2023 an on-call engineer could not log in remotely and reached the control centre 3 hours 15 minutes after the failure began.[8]

05 Agree who tells partners, and how fast

After the 2023 air traffic failure, several airlines and airports first heard of it from the media.[8]

06 Set weather triggers in advance

Decide which warnings cancel which services. In a red warning, police advise people to avoid travel in the affected area.[10]

PART 02

When it hits.

The first hour at a hub that has gone dark, keeping drivers and lone workers safe, rerouting, informing passengers and bringing partners into one response.

01 The first hour, and lane by lane

02 Missed check-ins and the driver log

03 Rerouting and messages ready to send

04 Contractors, partners and the notification log

THE FIRST HOUR

Thursday, 23:40: a substation fire cuts power to your main hub

Illustrative. The cause is not yours. The response is.

CLOCK	ACTION	OWNER
T+00:00	**Power lost at the hub** Lights, sortation and yard systems stop. Backup starts, but not everything is on it.	HUB DUTY MANAGER
T+00:05	**SEV 1 declared, log started** The team is alerted by call and SMS. Anyone silent after five minutes is called again.	INCIDENT MANAGER
T+00:10	**Account for everyone on site** Roll call of staff, agency workers, contractors and visiting drivers.	SITE SAFETY LEAD
T+00:15	**Stop inbound vehicles** Drivers heading in stop at a safe place and acknowledge. Nobody arrives at a dark yard.	TRANSPORT PLANNER
T+00:30	**Decide where the freight goes** No restoration time yet. Divert trunks to hubs with confirmed capacity.	OPERATIONS DIRECTOR
T+00:45	**Tell customers before they ask** Key customers hear what is affected and when the next update is.	CUSTOMER SERVICE · COMMS
T+01:00	**First crisis team review** People, freight, drivers' hours and the morning plan.	INCIDENT MANAGER

LANE BY LANE

The hub power loss, lane by lane

The same illustrative incident, showing who acts, who decides, where it goes wrong and how each step is watched.

	T+00:00	T+00:05	T+00:15	T+00:30	T+00:45	T+01:00
Drivers	! Trunks still heading for a dark yard	Stop alert: park safely, reply 1	! Three drivers silent after ten minutes	Replies and locations tracked	Rerouted to receiving hubs	Drivers' hours checked before onward legs
Hub and depots	! Backup covers only some systems	Duty manager raises the alarm, with location where supported	Roll call: staff, agency, visiting drivers	! Agency workers missing from the list	Roll call confirmed to incident manager	
Network control		◆ SEV 1 declared, log started	Silent leads called by second route	◆ Operations director: divert to hubs with capacity	Missed check-ins escalated to duty manager	◆ First review: people, freight, morning plan
Suppliers and partners		Network operator asked for an estimate	! No restoration time; plan for hours	Receiving hubs and hauliers told	Partners acknowledge; same update clock	
Customers and passengers				! Calls start before any message is sent	Key customers told impact and next update	Next update sent at the promised time

Action · Decision · Where it goes wrong · Monitored

Where it goes wrong: drivers who never got the stop message, people missing from the roll call and customers who hear nothing. **Who decides:** the incident manager declares and grades; the operations director decides where freight goes. **How it is monitored:** network control watches acknowledgements, check-ins and the time of the next update, and chases anything silent.

MISSED CHECK-INS

When a driver or lone worker stops answering

HSE guidance says employers must monitor lone workers and keep in touch with them, using pre-agreed intervals of regular contact, and test their emergency procedures regularly.[11] These times are illustrative.

	TRIGGER	WHO IS ALERTED	WHO DECIDES
LEVEL 1 **T+0 Missed check-in**	A driver or lone worker misses a scheduled check-in. The alert reaches the controller automatically, not by memory.	Network controller. The driver by app and SMS.	Network controller
↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS NO REPLY WITHIN 10 MINUTES			
LEVEL 2 **T+10 Contact**	No reply to the app or SMS.	The controller calls the driver, then the vehicle or site phone, then any colleague nearby.	Network controller
↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS STILL NO CONTACT BY T+20			
LEVEL 3 **T+20 Locate**	Still no contact. Record it in the check-in log as unresolved.	Duty manager and depot lead. Last known location and telematics checked.	Duty manager
↓ ESCALATE IF THERE IS STILL NO CONTACT BY T+30, OR ANY SIGN OF DANGER			
LEVEL 4 **T+30 Send help**	No contact, or any sign of danger at any point. Declare SEV 2, or SEV 1 if the driver is confirmed missing or hurt.	999 where there is any risk to life. Incident manager and health and safety lead. Family only through the agreed route.	Duty manager, with the incident manager

Call 999 at once if there is any sign of danger; do not wait for the next level. Shorten the times for higher risk work such as night parking or remote sites. Transport and storage recorded 15 worker deaths in 2025/26 in HSE's provisional figures, which do not include deaths in road traffic accidents.[12]

DRIVER CHECK-IN LOG

Driver and lone worker check-in log

One line per scheduled check-in. Network control keeps it on every night shift; a blank in the actual time column is a live escalation.

DRIVER AND VEHICLE	ROUTE OR LOCATION	DUE	ACTUAL	STATUS CODE	IF MISSED: ACTION AND TIME	CONTROLLER
Driver 14 · Vehicle 207	*Services, junction 5 (planned rest)*	*02:00*	*02:04*	*OK, parked*	*None*	*Initials*

Agree the rhythm before the shift: planned route, check-in times and a status code. Higher risk work, such as night parking or remote sites, gets shorter intervals. Record the outcome of every missed check-in, check on the person the next day and keep the log for the review.

REROUTING AND INFORMATION

Rerouting and keeping people informed

The 2023 air traffic review asked airlines and airports to develop a standardised suite of passenger information during major incidents.[9] The same discipline works for freight customers.

Decide the route, then say it once

Agree the diversion or alternative with the receiving site before announcing it. One instruction, one owner, one time stamp, sent to every site and driver affected.

Tell people what to do

Lead with the action: do not travel, rebook, collect from another depot, expect delivery tomorrow. Then explain the cause, if you know it.

Set the next update and keep it

Give a time for the next update, even if there will be nothing new. Silence is when rumours start and phone lines jam.

Reach people without data

Not everyone has the app. Use SMS, station and terminal staff, partner desks and recorded phone lines alongside the website.

MESSAGES

Six messages ready to send

Short, specific and honest. Fill the brackets, never guess the cause and always give the time of the next update.

SMS · DRIVERS ON THE ROAD — 141 chars

> SEV1: [Hub] has no power. Do not travel to site. Stop at [safe location] and reply 1 when parked. Next update 00:30. Call [number] if unsafe.

Ask for a reply so you know who has stopped.

PUSH · HUB STAFF AND CONTRACTORS

> Power loss at [Hub]. Stop work safely and go to [assembly point] for a roll call. Do not restart equipment. Supervisors will brief you there.

WEB BANNER · PASSENGERS

> Services from [terminal or station] are disrupted because of [a power failure]. Please do not travel to [location] today unless told your journey is running. Next update [10:00].

Lead with what to do. Add rebooking and refund links.

EMAIL · CUSTOMERS AND PARTNERS

> We are managing an incident at [site] affecting [services]. Freight is being diverted to [site]. Expect delays of [x hours]. We will update you at [time]. Contact [desk].

Partners should hear before the media does.

EMAIL · REGULATOR

> Initial notification: [Organisation] is managing an incident affecting [service] since [time]. Impact: [summary]. Cause: under investigation. Contact: [name, number]. Full report to follow.

NIS operators must notify within 72 hours; a Bill now before Parliament proposes 24 hours. [13,14]

HOLDING LINE · MEDIA

> We are aware of disruption affecting [services] and are working to restore them as quickly as possible. The safety of our passengers and colleagues comes first. We will share more information as soon as we can.

01

Bring contractors and partners into one response

Most transport incidents involve people you do not employ: network operators, system suppliers, hauliers, handlers, security and cleaning contractors, neighbouring sites. They need to hear early and act on the same facts.

KNOW WHO THEY ARE

Every partner that can stop your operation, or be stopped by it, with a 24-hour contact and a named owner.

TELL THEM FIRST

Partners should hear from you, not the news. Agree in contracts how fast you tell each other.

SHARE ONE CLOCK

Key partners join the incident log or call, with the same severity scale and update times.

PLAN FOR THEIR FAILURE

JLR set up early payment financing for suppliers critical to its restart.[5] Ask what yours would need.

OWNER

Head of operations, with procurement

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

PARTNER NOTIFICATION LOG

Partner and supplier notification log

Who must hear from you, who told them, when, and whether they acknowledged. Fill in the first three columns before winter.

PARTNER OR SUPPLIER	WHAT THEY DO FOR US	24-HOUR CONTACT	TOLD AT	TOLD BY	ACKNOWLEDGED	NEXT UPDATE
Planning system supplier	*Route planning and labels*	*24-hour service desk*	*22:12*	*Network control*	*22:15, by phone*	*23:00*

After the 2023 air traffic failure, several airlines and airports first heard about it from the media.[8] A partner that is not on this log will not be told.

PART 03

Recover and rehearse.

Three scenarios to test your plan, a tabletop exercise, the tools to track and review the response, and a dated plan with owners.

01 Three scenarios

02 A tabletop exercise

03 Outstanding actions and the review

04 Your plan, questions and checklist

SCENARIOS

Three illustrative scenarios: where they go wrong and who decides

REGIONAL BUS AND COACH OPERATOR

A red wind warning on a weekday morning

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Deciding route by route at 05:00, with drivers already out and passengers waiting at stops.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Hourly driver check-ins and a live list of routes running, held or cancelled.

WHO DECIDES

The operations director at a 04:30 call, on triggers agreed in advance.

REHEARSE

Walk through the 04:30 decision call with depot leads.

PARCEL AND FREIGHT NETWORK

The planning system supplier is hit by ransomware

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Waiting for the supplier before telling sites and customers anything.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Depot acknowledgements, loads dispatched against plan and a supplier update on a fixed clock.

WHO DECIDES

The incident manager declares; the operations director moves hubs to the offline route pack.

REHEARSE

Run one hub for two hours without the planning system.

AIRPORT GROUND HANDLER

Check-in and bag drop go down at 06:00

WHERE IT GOES WRONG

Each airline saying something different at its own desks as queues build.

HOW IT IS MONITORED

Queue times, desks open on manual kits and one agreed passenger message.

WHO DECIDES

The terminal duty manager, with airline station managers, on one manual check-in plan.

REHEARSE

A 30-minute manual check-in drill with airline partners.

TABLETOP EXERCISE

Exercise: the planning system goes dark at night

Illustrative. A supplier cyber attack, run as a facilitated discussion. Release each inject only when the room has answered the last.

DURATION	PARTICIPANTS	OBJECTIVE	FACILITATOR
Two and a half hours	Operations, network control, two depot leads, safety, comms, IT, a key haulier	Test the divert decision, missed check-ins and partner notice at night	Head of resilience, with an observer keeping the log

22:00	INJECT 1 Route planning and label printing fail across the network. The supplier says it is investigating.	DISCUSS Who declares, and at what severity? How are depots told? What do drivers already loaded do?
22:20	INJECT 2 The supplier confirms a suspected cyber attack and cannot give a restoration time.	DISCUSS Do you cut any connections? Who decides to switch to the offline route pack? Who considers regulator notification?
23:10	INJECT 3 A driver on a rural route misses two check-ins. The phone goes to voicemail.	DISCUSS Who owns the escalation, and what times apply? At what point do you call 999?
00:30	INJECT 4 A national news site reports the outage and names your company.	DISCUSS Who speaks? Have customers and partners already heard from you?
02:00	INJECT 5 Two depots report the offline pack is out of date for key customers.	DISCUSS Who decides which loads go first? How is that tracked and reported?
05:30	INJECT 6 The morning shift starts. The system is still down.	DISCUSS What runs, what is cancelled, and who tells customers before 07:00? Which actions are still outstanding?

> Afterwards, record the decisions, the gaps and an owner for each fix in the review template, and add every action to the tracker.

OUTSTANDING ACTIONS

Outstanding actions, the morning after

Illustrative, following the hub power loss. The incident manager reviews this board at every update; every action has an owner, a due time and a way to check it is done.

ACTION	OWNER	DUE	STATUS	HOW IT IS CHECKED
Account for the agency worker missing from the roll call	Depot lead	00:20	DONE	Agency confirmation recorded in the log
Confirm drivers held overnight are rested and fit to drive	Network control	05:00	DONE	Check-in log and drivers' hours records
Get a written restoration estimate from the network operator	Engineering lead	06:00	BLOCKED	Estimate logged; chased every hour
Send customers the 07:00 update	Comms and customer service	07:00	OVERDUE	Sent time compared with promised time
Clear diverted freight at receiving hubs	Operations director	Day 2	IN PROGRESS	Volumes reported at each review
Test how long backup power lasts before reopening	Engineering lead	Day 2	OPEN	Test result signed off by the site lead
Call the three drivers who missed check-ins	Health and safety lead	Day 2	OPEN	Welfare call recorded for each driver
Decide whether a regulator notification is needed	Incident manager, with legal	Within 72 h	IN PROGRESS	Decision and reasons recorded
Book the post-incident review with partners	Incident manager	Day 5	OPEN	Each partner has accepted

> Anything overdue or blocked goes to the top of the next crisis team review, with one named person to unblock it.

POST-INCIDENT REVIEW

Post-incident review template

Complete within two weeks, with partners in the room. Look for what the system allowed to happen, not for someone to blame.

INCIDENT	DATE	SEVERITY	REVIEW LEAD

01 What happened

A short timeline from first alert to stand-down. Which sites, routes, drivers and partners were affected?

02 People and welfare

Was everyone accounted for? How long did each missed check-in take to resolve?

03 Alerting and acknowledgement

How was it first reported? How long until the right people acknowledged, and who did not?

04 Decisions

Which decisions were made, by whom, when and on what information? Which waited too long?

05 Partners and suppliers

When was each partner told? Did any hear first from the media or a customer?

06 Customers and passengers

Were updates sent on time, in plain language and on more than one channel?

07 What worked, what did not

Backup duration, manual procedures, diversions and the incident log.

08 Actions

Each fix with an owner, a due date and how completion will be checked. Report to the board.

YOUR PLAN

This week, this month, this quarter

Owners are suggestions. Adjust them to your structure, and date every action.

WHEN	ACTIONS	OWNER
This week	Publish the severity ladder, escalation levels, roles matrix and the six message templates to every site. Confirm a second contact route for every key person.	Head of resilience
This week	Put the driver check-in log and missed check-in escalation live on every night shift, and test it.	Head of health and safety
This month	Map single points of failure: power, control rooms, systems and suppliers. Test how long each backup lasts.	Engineering and IT leads
This month	Agree partner notification routes and 24-hour contacts with your top 20 suppliers and partners.	Head of operations, with procurement
This quarter	Run the tabletop exercise in this playbook with partners, then a hub power loss at night. Track every fix.	Operations director
This quarter	Check regulator reporting duties and timings. Report gaps and dated fixes to the board.	Chief operating officer, with legal

FOR LEADERS

Questions for your leadership team

Ask them out loud. Vague answers are the finding.

RESILIENCE

- ? If our main hub or terminal lost power tonight, how long would backup last, and what would stop first?
- ? Which single supplier or system could stop our whole operation, and what is the fallback?
- ? How quickly would every partner site and driver have one clear instruction?

PEOPLE

- ? How do we know, minute by minute, that every lone worker and driver is safe?
- ? Could every key decision maker be reached at 1am if their phone was on silent?
- ? Do passengers and customers hear from us before they hear from the media?

CHECKLIST

Are you ready to keep it moving?

Tick what is true today. Anything blank is your next action.

- [ ] **One severity ladder used by every site and key partner**
  With named owners and alert routes for each level.

- [ ] **Single points of failure mapped and backup duration known**
  Power, control rooms, systems and suppliers.

- [ ] **Two routes to every key decision maker**
  Tested out of hours, not only in office time.

- [ ] **Lone worker and driver check-ins live on every shift**
  With automatic alerts for missed check-ins.

- [ ] **Message templates approved and loaded**
  Drivers, staff, passengers, customers, regulators and media.

- [ ] **Partner contacts current and notification agreed**
  Including 24-hour numbers for critical suppliers.

- [ ] **Manual or offline procedures tested this quarter**
  Planning, check-in, dispatch and gate control.

- [ ] **Regulator reporting duties understood**
  Who reports what, to whom, and by when.

GLOSSARY

Words worth knowing

Severity level
A shared grade (SEV 1 to SEV 4) that sets who is alerted, how fast and how often.

Single point of failure
One component, site, system or supplier whose loss stops the whole operation.

Supply point
A connection to the electricity network. Large sites may have several, each feeding different systems.

Backup duration
How long a generator, battery or other fallback can run before it is exhausted.

Lone worker
Anyone who works without close or direct supervision, such as a driver or night security officer.

Welfare check
A planned contact to confirm a lone worker or driver is safe.

Trunking
Moving freight in bulk between hubs, usually overnight.

Diversion
Sending vehicles, freight or passengers through another site or route.

Manual fallback
A paper or offline way of doing a task when the system is down.

NIS Regulations
The Network and Information Systems Regulations 2018, which set security and incident reporting duties for essential services, including transport.

Competent authority
The regulator for an essential service under the NIS Regulations.

Holding line
A short, accurate statement used while facts are still being established.

Acknowledgement
A recipient's confirmation that an alert has been read and acted on.

Incident manager
The person who runs the response, keeps the log and sets the rhythm of updates.

WHY COORDINATION, NOT JUST NOTIFICATION

Most organisations can send alerts. Few can manage incidents end-to-end.

When a substation fire cuts power to a hub at 23:40, the alert is minute one. Keeping goods and people moving depends on which drivers are safe, which partners know, what passengers or customers were told, and a clear record of who decided what.

WHERE INCIDENTS GO WRONG

01	**Fragmented information**	Different teams work from different information.
02	**Delayed decision making**	Leadership lacks visibility, so decisions wait.
03	**Uncoordinated response**	Several teams work independently on the same problem.
04	**Lack of visibility**	Critical actions become difficult to track.
05	**Lack of accountability**	Actions and decisions are poorly documented.

THE WHOLE INCIDENT, IN ONE PLATFORM



Crises Control is an **Operational Incident Coordination Platform**. It helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform.

THE PLATFORM

One connected platform, from first alert to final report.

Crises Control helps organisations maintain operational control during incidents by combining alerting, coordination, execution, visibility and accountability in one platform. Each module does one job; the value comes from how they work together across the incident.

01

ESCALATE

SOS

Frontline staff report an incident in one touch from a mobile device.

02

START

Ping

Alerting and activation: reach people and collect acknowledgements and responses.

03

COORDINATE

Incident Manager

Activate the incident, assign roles, control communication and keep the timeline.

04

EXECUTE

Task Manager

Assign actions, track completion and escalate what stalls, with clear accountability.

05

OPERATE

Control Centre

Real-time view of incidents, timelines, task status and assets.

06

PROVE

Audit & Reporting

Incident records, response analysis and task accountability, ready to report.

07

ASSIST

CRAiG

AI assistant that helps users find information and work through the incident.

THE OUTCOMES

Alerting and activation

Reach the right people immediately.

Operational coordination

Structure communication and response activities.

Execution and visibility

Track tasks, responsibilities and progress.

Proof and accountability

Create a complete, defensible operational record.

Most organisations start with the capability they need today, often alerting, and expand as their requirements mature. Highlighted modules are the ones this playbook draws on.

HOW THE MODULES WORK TOGETHER

How the modules work together in a transport incident

The hub power loss from this playbook, followed through the platform from the first alarm to the review.

01	ESCALATE **SOS**	A depot duty manager or a driver on their own raises the alarm in one touch, with their location where supported.
02	START **Ping**	Drivers, depot staff and partners are alerted by push, SMS and voice; anyone silent is chased and escalated automatically.
03	COORDINATE **Incident Manager**	The incident manager declares SEV 1, assigns network roles and keeps one log shared with partner sites and suppliers.
04	EXECUTE **Task Manager**	Roll call, missed check-in escalation, diversion and customer updates run as owned tasks with deadlines.
05	OPERATE **Control Centre**	Network control sees affected sites, drivers stopped safely, overdue check-ins and outstanding actions in one live view.
06	PROVE **Audit & Reporting**	A timestamped record of every alert, acknowledgement and decision supports the review, insurers and regulators.
07	ASSIST **CRAiG**	CRAiG helps the incident team find which drivers have not checked in and which actions are still outstanding.

COORDINATION
Everyone works from the same incident, roles and log.

VISIBILITY
Leaders see progress without chasing for updates.

EXECUTION
Every action has an owner, a deadline and an escalation.

ACCOUNTABILITY
The record of what happened builds itself as you go.

USE CASES

How organisations use Crises Control in transport and logistics

From the first alert to the final record: the incidents this platform is used for, and how the modules work together in each.

Aviation emergency and crisis team mobilisation

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER Aircraft incident, offshore aviation emergency or other serious operational event

Alert predefined crisis team members, capture acknowledgements and availability, activate response procedures and coordinate role-specific actions.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

Crew safety and SOS assistance

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER A pilot, flight attendant or other frontline worker requires urgent assistance

Allow the individual to raise an SOS alert, share location where supported and notify the appropriate response personnel.

SOS | Ping | Incident Manager | Control Centre

Severity assessment and structured incident response

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER An operational event needs initial assessment before a full response is activated

Use an initial notification to assess severity, then launch a structured incident, alert affected users, assign tasks and document actions and evidence.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Media Assets Manager | Audit & Reporting

Operational service disruption

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER Ferry or other operational service is disrupted, including out of hours

Alert predefined response groups, track acknowledgements, repeat notifications where configured and coordinate recovery actions.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre

Multi-location and international incident coordination

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER An incident requires response from teams in different countries or operating locations

Mobilise geographically dispersed teams, keep relevant stakeholders informed and maintain a shared record of incident activity.

Ping | Incident Manager | Task Manager | Control Centre | Audit & Reporting

Operational communications resilience

CUSTOMER EXAMPLE

TRIGGER Normal communication channels are unavailable, degraded or insufficient

Use independent communication channels to reach internal teams and relevant external contacts, track delivery and acknowledgements, and retain an auditable record.

Ping | Incident Manager | Audit & Reporting | integrations where configured

Customer examples are based on how customers use Crises Control today; customer names have been removed. Customer requirements describe needs raised by customers or in evaluations. Intended, suggested and illustrative use cases show how the platform can be applied and are not presented as existing customer deployments. Capabilities marked 'where configured' or 'where supported' depend on each organisation's set-up.

READINESS ASSESSMENT

How ready is your response?

Score each area from 0 (not in place) to 3 (fully in place) for your transport and logistics organisation, then add up the total.

AREA	THE QUESTION	SCORE 0 TO 3
01 · ACTIVATION **Alert**	Can you reach the right people on more than one channel within minutes, day or night? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Drivers, depot staff, partners and contractors reached on several channels, at any hour.	0 1 2 3
02 · ACTIVATION **Acknowledge**	Do you know who has seen the alert, and does silence trigger escalation automatically? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Acknowledgement and welfare checks for lone and remote workers, with escalation on silence.	0 1 2 3
03 · COORDINATION **Escalate**	Are escalation paths set by role and time, not by whoever remembers who to call? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Escalation to duty managers and partner organisations runs by rule.	0 1 2 3
04 · COORDINATION **Coordinate**	Is there one shared workspace and log for the incident, not scattered calls, chats and inboxes? GOOD LOOKS LIKE One incident log shared by operations, partners and customer communications.	0 1 2 3
05 · EXECUTION **Execute**	Are your procedures turned into owned tasks with deadlines that someone can track? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Rerouting and recovery steps run as owned tasks across sites.	0 1 2 3
06 · EXECUTION **See**	Can leaders see tasks, people, locations and blockers live, without having to ask? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A live view of sites, people, vehicles and outstanding actions.	0 1 2 3
07 · ASSURANCE **Prove**	Could you produce a timestamped timeline for a regulator, insurer or inquiry within a day? GOOD LOOKS LIKE A timeline that supports regulators, insurers and the post-incident review.	0 1 2 3
08 · ASSURANCE **Rehearse**	Do you exercise the whole response, not just the call tree, at least once a year? GOOD LOOKS LIKE Multi-partner exercises that include a second means of contact for key people.	0 1 2 3

0 to 8
Alerting only
You can send messages. The response still depends on people and luck.

9 to 16
Coordinating in parts
Some steps work. Gaps appear at night, at scale or when systems fail.

17 to 24
Coordinated and provable
You can run the response and show exactly what happened.

BUYER'S GUIDE

Eight questions to ask any incident platform supplier

Many tools can send an alert. These questions separate a notification tool from a platform that coordinates the whole response.

01 **Does it stop at the message?**
Ask what the platform does after the alert is sent: tasks, log, escalation, recovery.

02 **Can it prove who acknowledged?**
Delivery is not acknowledgement. Ask how silence is detected and escalated.

03 **Does it run your procedures?**
Ask whether your plans become owned tasks with deadlines, or stay as documents.

04 **Is there one shared picture?**
Ask what leaders see live, and whether it needs someone to update a spreadsheet.

05 **Does it work when your systems do not?**
Ask how teams coordinate if email, chat or your network is down.

06 **Can frontline staff raise the alarm?**
Ask how a colleague on site escalates, with their location where supported, in one action.

07 **What evidence does it leave behind?**
Ask for a sample timeline of the kind a regulator, insurer or inquiry would want.

08 **Can you rehearse in it?**
Ask whether you can run exercises on the same platform you would use for real.

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BOOK YOUR TRANSPORT AND LOGISTICS PLATFORM DEMONSTRATION

Watch a hub power loss run end to end.

A live, 30-minute demonstration built around a transport and logistics incident. You will see one incident move through the whole platform, not a tour of features, and you can bring your own scenario.

WHAT YOU WILL SEE

01	SOS	A depot supervisor reports a power loss, with location where supported.
02	PING	Drivers, depots and partners are alerted; drivers check in.
03	INCIDENT MANAGER	The duty manager activates the incident and assigns network roles.
04	TASK MANAGER	Rerouting, customer updates and welfare checks become owned tasks.
05	CONTROL CENTRE	Operations sees sites, drivers, vehicles and actions outstanding.
06	AUDIT & REPORTING	The response record is produced for partners, insurers and regulators.
07	CRAIG	CRAiG helps the duty manager find information and guidance in the platform.

Book your demonstration →

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SCAN TO BOOK

COMPANION REPORT The Heathrow lesson